UFCFTR-30-3 Distributed and Enterprise Software Development

Week 7: Module Introduction, Camunda Set-up and Group Formation

Duration: 2 hours

Before You Start

This first practical session is about getting set up rather than producing a deliverable. There are four activities: introductions, exploring Camunda, requesting your Camunda account, and forming your assessment group. Work through them in order.

The tutorial-only case study used for the rest of the term will be introduced in the Week 8 tutorial, so no case study is needed today.

Part 1: Introductions

You will be working with the same people for the whole of this academic year. It is worth spending the first part of the session getting to know them.

A: Meet Your Tutor

Your tutor will introduce themselves and explain:

- Which practical sessions they run and where to find them
- How they prefer to be contacted, and what response time you should expect
- How the weekly stand-ups and sprint reviews will run in your session

The full module team and their contact details are listed in the Week 7 lecture slides on Blackboard. Make a note of the tutor for your own session, as this is the person you will contact about Camunda access, group membership and stand-ups.

B: Meet Your Cohort

Working in small groups of four or five around a table, introduce yourselves to each other. Each person should cover:

- Your name and the pathway or award you are studying
- Your experience with the tools used on this module: Python, Django, Docker, Git, and any process modelling you have done before
- One technical strength you would bring to a development team
- One area you would like to improve this year

There is no assumption that you have used BPMN or Camunda before. Most students will not have done, and the coming lectures introduce the concepts from the beginning.

C: Skills Inventory

As a table, record what your group covers collectively. Use the whiteboard or a shared note:

Skill or tool	**Who has used it**	**Confidence (low / medium / high)**
Python		
Django or another web framework		
Docker or containers		
Git and GitHub/GitLab		
Process modelling (BPMN, UML, flowcharts)		
Project management tools (Jira, Trello, etc.)		

Keep this inventory. A group with a spread of strengths across these rows is in a better position than a group where everyone has the same background, and this will be useful when you come to Part 4.

Part 2: Exploring Camunda

Camunda is the primary tool used in the Autumn Term (TB1) for modelling business processes with BPMN, and later in the term for making those models executable. Assessment Task 1 is built entirely around it, so time spent becoming comfortable with the tool now is time well spent.

Camunda publishes a free, self-paced course catalogue. Open the on-demand page and create an Academy account with your UWE student email address:

https://academy.camunda.com/page/on-demand

Suggested Starting Point

The catalogue is large. The following courses are a sensible order for someone who has not used Camunda or BPMN before:

Course	What it covers	Approximate time
Introduction to Camunda	What Camunda is and what problem it solves	20 minutes
Camunda 8 - Overview	The components of the platform and how they fit together	20 minutes
BPMN - Overview	The BPMN 2.0 notation: events, activities, gateways and flows	1 hour
BPMN - Task Types	The different task types available and when to use each	30 minutes
BPMN - Creating Readable Process Models	Conventions that make a model understandable to other people	30 minutes

You are not expected to complete all of these during the session, and you are not expected to master the material. Lectures and tutorials in the coming weeks introduce BPMN and Camunda properly. The purpose of this activity is simply to get you looking at the tool before it is taught.

Exploration Prompts

As you work through the material, keep the following questions in mind:

- What are the basic building blocks of a BPMN diagram?
- What is the difference between an event and a task?
- What does a gateway represent in a process?
- What does it mean for a process model to be executable rather than just documentation?

Write down any terminology you do not recognise and bring that list to next week's session. Questions from this list are a useful starting point for the lecture discussion.

Self-Directed Learning

This activity is self-directed and is not assessed, but it is strongly encouraged. Students who explore the tool early tend to find the modelling work in Assessment Task 1 considerably easier. You are free to continue working through the Academy catalogue in your own time throughout the term.

Part 3: Getting Your Camunda Account

There are two separate accounts involved, and it is worth being clear about the difference:

- **Camunda Academy account:** you create this yourself, for free, to access the courses in Part 2.
- **Camunda 8 account:** this gives you access to the Web Modeler inside the module's Camunda organisation, which is where you will build and run your models in the coming weeks. This account cannot be self-registered. We have secured the official Camunda license for our students. Your tutor needs to invite you manually.

What You Need to Do

1. Speak to your tutor during this session and give them your UWE student email address. Your personal email address will not work, as the invitation is issued against your university account.
2. Your tutor will send an invitation to the module's Camunda organisation. This is a manual step, so please be patient if there are several requests in the same session.
3. Check your UWE inbox for the invitation email and accept it. Check your junk folder if it does not appear.
4. Sign in and confirm you can reach the Web Modeler at https://console.camunda.io
5. Create an empty BPMN diagram to confirm your access works. You do not need to model anything meaningful yet.

Note: *You must have access to Camunda 8 Web Modeler before the start of Sprint 1.*

Part 4: Forming Your Assessment Group

Both assessed tasks on this module are group projects run over three sprints each, and the group you form now stays with you across

Assessment Task 1 in the Autumn Term and Assessment Task 2 in the Spring Term. Weekly stand-ups and sprint reviews are run with your group, and individual contribution within the group is assessed. The Week 7 lecture slides set out the full detail.

Group Size

- Groups must have a minimum of 4 and a maximum of 5 members.
- Groups of 3 or fewer are not permitted and will be merged.

Which Session Your Group Comes From

- You are encouraged to form your group from students in your own timetabled practical session. This keeps stand-ups and sprint reviews simple for everyone.
- Groups formed across different practical sessions are permitted. If you do this, the group must agree on one common session to attend together for the rest of the year and must tell the tutor which session that is.
- Where possible, members joining from another session should request a formal timetable change.
- Attendance codes are tied to your official timetabled session and will not work in a session you are not registered for. Bear this in mind before committing to a cross-session group.

Deadlines

- **Self-selection closes at 23:59 on 7 October 2026.**
- Any student without a group after that point will be allocated at random, either to a new group or to an existing group with fewer than 5 members.
- **Group membership is final once Sprint 1 begins on 12 October 2026.**

Registering Your Group

Once your group is agreed, register it using the DESD Group Formation 2026-27 form. Scan the QR code below or use the link, and follow the instructions on the form itself.



DESD Group Formation 2026-27 Form

https://forms.cloud.microsoft/e/bfM3b2yuDW

If you have not found a group by the end of this session, speak to your tutor before you leave. It is far easier to place you now than after the deadline.